

On May 2, a woman mailed the following letter to a man: "May 1 I have two tickets to the concert on July 1 at the auditorium in town. I'll sell them to you for \$60 per ticket, which is \$10 above face value. Since the concert has been sold out for months, I think that is a good deal. You have 15 days from the above date to decide whether to accept this offer." The man received the letter on May 4, but did not read it until May 6. On May 18, the man went to the woman's home and attempted to accept the offer. The woman replied: "Too late! I sold the tickets last week for \$75 each." Assume that the woman's letter created in the man a valid power of acceptance. Was that power terminated by lapse of time before the man went to the woman's home on May 17? (Correct Answer: B)

- A. Yes, because the letter was mailed on May 2.
- B. Yes, because the letter was dated May 1.
- C. No, because the man received the letter on May 4.
- D. No, because the man did not read the letter until May 6.

CoT Reasoning

- Option A: Yes, because the letter was mailed on May 2.**
This option suggests that the date the letter was mailed determines the validity of the acceptance period. However, the power of acceptance is based on the time frame given in the letter, which was 15 days from the date of the letter (May 1). Thus, the date of mailing alone is not sufficient to terminate the power of acceptance.
- Option B: Yes, because the letter was dated May 1.**
Similar to Option A, this option focuses on the date of the letter itself. While the letter was indeed dated May 1, the acceptance period should be calculated from when the man received the letter, not from the date written on it.
- Option C: No, because the man received the letter on May 4.**
This option correctly identifies that the man received the letter on May 4. Given that he had 15 days from when he received the letter to accept the offer, his acceptance period would end on May 19. Since he attempted to accept on May 18, he was still within the time frame.
- Option D: No, because the man did not read the letter until May 6.**
This option suggests that the acceptance period should start from when the man read the letter. However, receipt of the letter is what matters for the acceptance period, not when it was read.

Final Answer: C (Wrong Answer)



Reverse Thinking Approach

- Start with the man's acceptance on May 18.
The letter gave 15 days from May 1 to accept, so the offer expired on May 16.
His acceptance came after the deadline.
- Option D (read on May 6) and Option C (received on May 4) do not impact the deadline.
Option A (mailed May 2) is also irrelevant.
- Only Option B correctly identifies May 1 as the starting point for the 15-day period. Hence, the acceptance was too late, and Option B is the correct choice under both reasoning approaches.

Final Answer: B (Correct Answer)